COURSE SLIDES · NON-WSQ

Mastering Service Branding Strategies to Grow Your Business



Course Code: C233

Conducted by Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd · UEN 201200696W

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COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome and Course Orientation

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About the Trainer



Your Trainer

General trainer template — to be completed by the trainer

NAME

TITLE / DESIGNATION

QUALIFICATIONS

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

TRAINING & INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

CONTACT

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YOUR TRAINER

About the Trainer



Dr. Alfred Ang

Principal Trainer · Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

ROLE
Principal Trainer and course facilitator

SPECIALISMS
Service strategy, digital experience and workplace transformation

DELIVERY
Professional development and applied business learning

CONTACT
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INTRODUCTION

Let's Know Each Other

1

Role

Your organisation, function and customer responsibilities.

2

Service moment

One memorable service experience and why it stayed with you.

3

Brand challenge

One gap between a promise and actual delivery.

4

Learning goal

One service-brand decision you want to improve today.

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HOUSEKEEPING

Ground Rules

1. **Participate**
   Challenge assumptions and contribute evidence.

2. **Respect**
   Disagree with ideas, not people.

3. **Confidentiality**
   Use public or course data only; protect live customer information.

4. **Devices**
   Silent mode; step out quietly if needed.

5. **Time**
   Return from lunch promptly.

6. **Full attendance**
   Attend the full day to get the most from the course.

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LESSON PLAN

Course Outline — 1 Day

Morning

- Morning — Define and design
  - Topic 1: value, trust and business impact
  - Activities 1–2: Babylist and DBS
  - Topic 2: strategy, promise and touchpoints
  - Activities 3–4: Ritz-Carlton and Starbucks

Afternoon

- Afternoon — Activate and evaluate
  - Topic 3: employee adoption and recovery
  - Activities 5–6: Zappos and Airbnb
  - Topic 4: measures and improvement
  - Activities 7–8; course recap and feedback

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ACTIVITY MATERIALS

Access the Course Activities

https://www.tertiarycourses.com.sg/mastering-service-branding-strategies-to-grow-your-business.html

Course page

Open the course registration page for details and materials.

Activity packs

The trainer issues the eight activity folders in the training room.

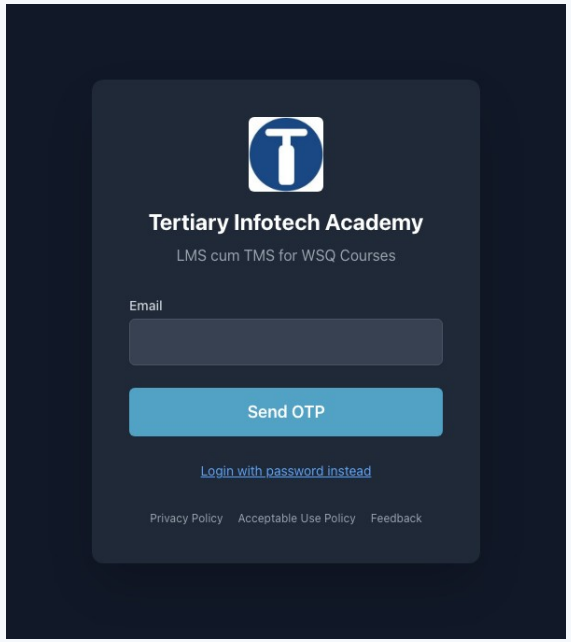
One folder each

Every activity contains scenario, questions, procedure, debrief and evidence.

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COURSEWARE

Download Course Material



https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com/

1

Sign in

Open the LMS with your registered email; use the OTP or your password.

2

Open course

Select this course from your enrolled courses.

3

Download

Download the slides and the Learner Guide.

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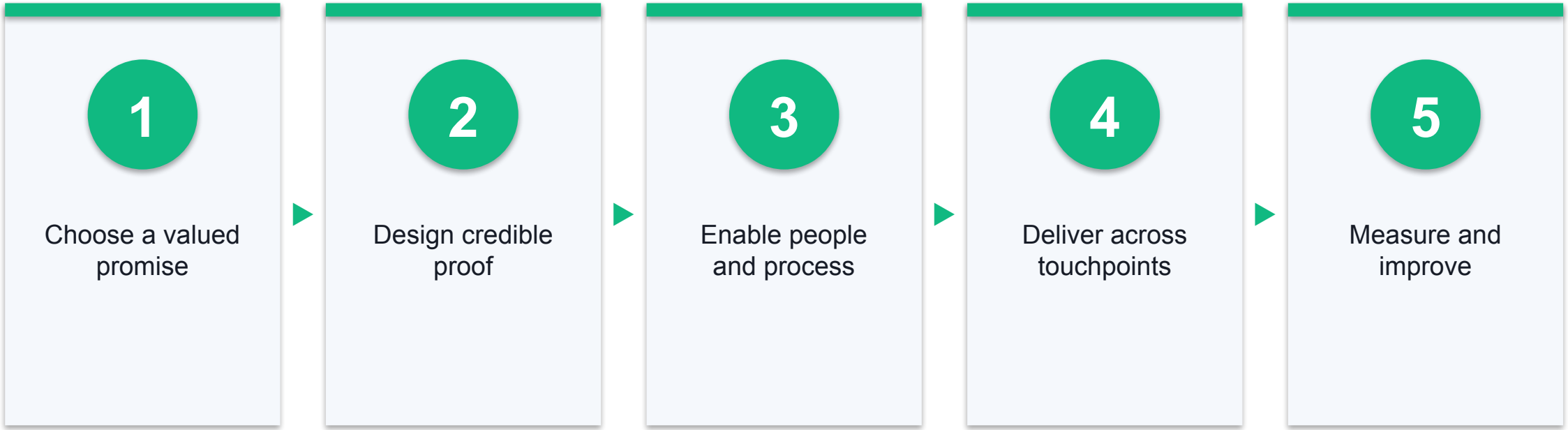
CORE MODEL

Promise · Proof · People · Performance

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END-TO-END VIEW

The service-brand operating system



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EVIDENCE BEFORE CONFIDENCE

Evidence hierarchy

1

Verified public fact

Published information with a source and date.

2

Organisation evidence

Research, journey data, standards, logs and decisions.

3

Training assumption

A simulated input used only for learning and clearly labelled.

4

Evaluation finding

A conclusion with method, limitation, owner and next action.

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COURSE MODEL

The brand promise is credible only when the operating system can deliver it.

Service branding aligns strategy, people, process, evidence and customer experience.

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01

LEARNING UNIT 01

Service Brand Value and Business Impact

Intangibility · trust · risk reduction · differentiation · commercial value

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KEY CONCEPTS

Key Concepts — Service Brand Value and Business Impact

1

Promise

A service brand sets an expectation about the outcome and treatment customers should receive.

2

Experience

Customers interpret the brand through people, processes, physical and digital evidence.

3

Trust

Consistent proof lowers perceived risk before an intangible service can be evaluated.

4

Value

A strong service brand can support preference, loyalty, referrals, resilience and price confidence.

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TOPIC 01

A service brand is a promise made visible through experience.

Identity attracts attention; repeated delivery earns belief.

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TOPIC 01

Why services need a different branding lens

1

Intangible

Customers cannot inspect the full service before buying; cues and proof reduce uncertainty.

2

Inseparable

Employees and customers often co-produce the experience in real time.

3

Variable

Performance can change across people, channels, locations and moments.

4

Perishable

Unused capacity cannot be stored; demand and access shape the experience.

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TOPIC 01

Value is co-created, not merely exchanged

The product era · goods-dominant logic

- Goods-dominant logic: value is built into the offering and realised at the point of sale.
- The customer is a passive recipient of what was produced.
- Attention sits on value-in-exchange — the price paid.

The service era · service-dominant logic

- Service-dominant logic: value is intangible and created with the customer in real time.
- The customer is an active partner in producing the outcome.
- Attention sits on value-in-use — the benefit actually realised.

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TOPIC 01

Perceived risk rises as tangibility falls

Easy to evaluate · lower risk → Hard to evaluate · higher risk

Search qualities

Can be judged before purchase by direct inspection, such as a room, a menu or a device.

Experience qualities

Can be judged only after use, such as a meal, a stay, a course or a consultation.

Credence qualities

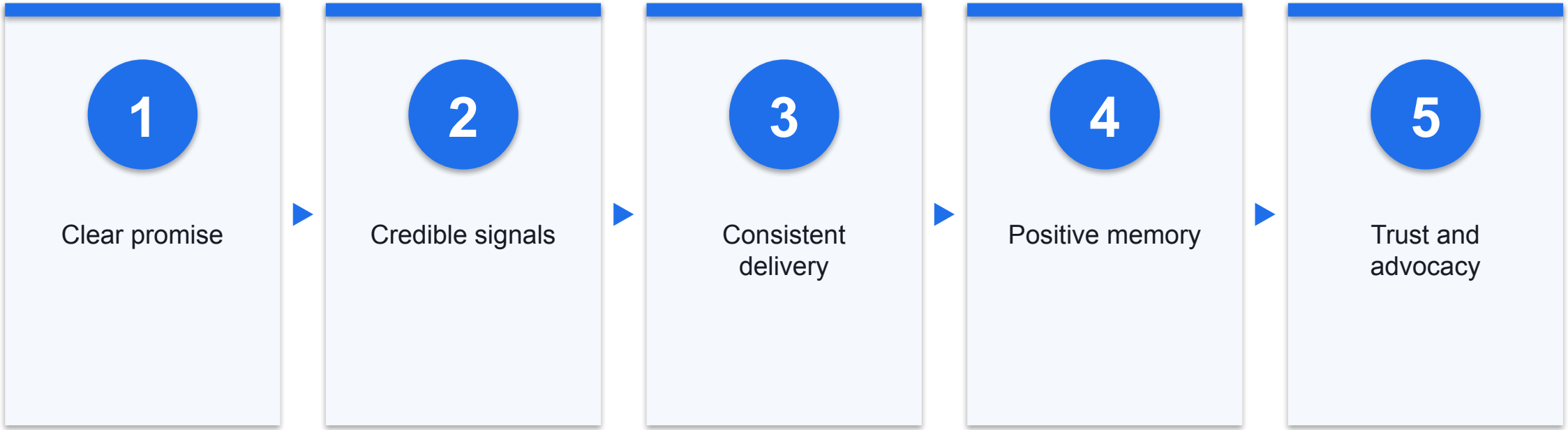
Hard to judge even after use because the customer lacks the expertise, such as legal, medical or advisory work.

Why it matters: As an offer moves toward credence, customers lean on risk relievers instead of inspection: standards, guarantees, credentials and brand reputation. That is the work a service brand does.

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TOPIC 01

How service-brand value is created



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TOPIC 01

Benefits across the business

1

Customer

Faster recognition, lower perceived risk and clearer reasons to choose.

2

Employee

Shared standards and meaning guide judgement at moments that matter.

3

Commercial

Preference, retention, referrals and premium confidence can strengthen economics.

4

Strategic

A coherent brand focuses investment and makes expansion easier to govern.

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TOPIC 01

Brand identity and brand meaning

Perspective A

- Identity is what the organisation intends: name, promise, voice, design and standards.
- Management can define and communicate these signals.
- They create expectations before service use.

Perspective B

- Meaning is what customers and employees conclude from lived experience.
- It is shaped by outcomes, emotions, stories and recovery.
- It cannot be declared into existence.

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TOPIC 01

Each service characteristic sets a branding task

1

Intangibility → evidence

Cannot be touched or inspected, so supply physical and peripheral cues that stand in for inspection.

2

Inseparability → interaction

Produced and consumed at the same moment, so manage the customer–employee encounter directly.

3

Perishability → capacity

Cannot be stored, so match supply to demand through scheduling, access and pricing.

4

Variability → standards

Quality depends on human actors, so standardise the core process and invest in frontline capability.

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TOPIC 01

Sell the capability, not the component

What the evidence shows

- The object is a distribution mechanism; the customer buys the outcome it enables.
- A streaming service sells discovery and access, not ownership of recordings.
- A sportswear brand sells athletic progress through apps, community and tracking, not only footwear.

What it means for your brand

- Ask what capability the customer gains, not what the organisation hands over.
- Define the promise around the realised benefit so it survives changes in the delivery mechanism.
- Value emerges across an ecosystem of customers, employees, partners and digital tools.

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TOPIC 01

Three forms of service-brand proof

Performance

- Reliable outcomes, accuracy, timeliness and problem resolution.

People

- Competence, empathy, judgement and confidence in the promise.

Evidence

- Environment, content, reviews, cases, process visibility and guarantees.

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TOPIC 01

The 7Ps as brand-delivery levers

1

Proposition

Product/service, price and promotion frame the value and expectation.

2

Access

Place and channel determine convenience, inclusion and reach.

3

Delivery

People and process convert the promise into customer outcomes.

4

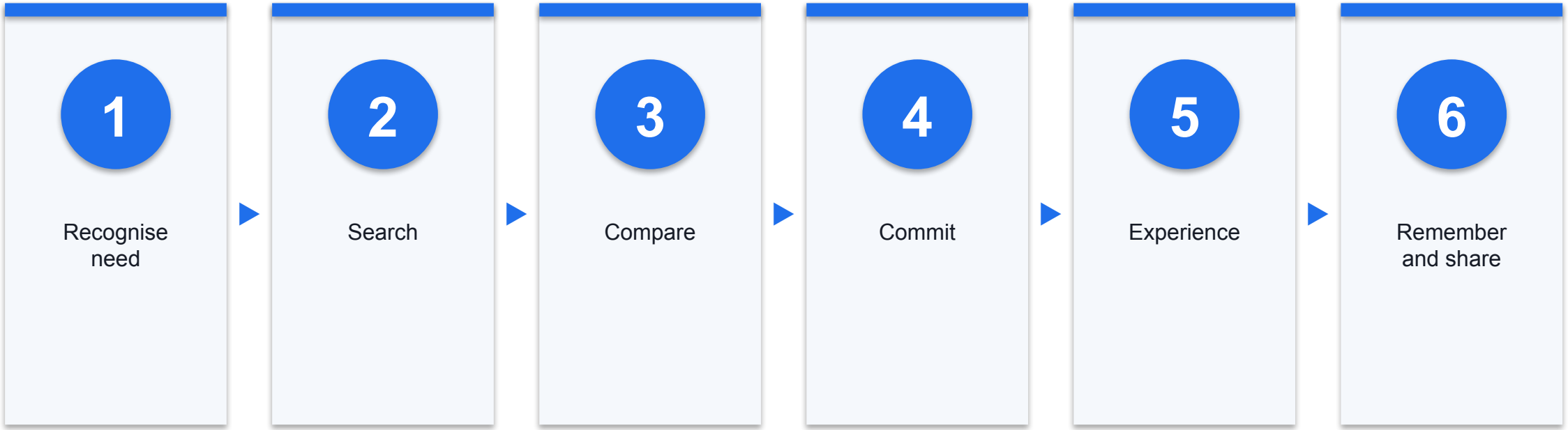
Proof

Physical evidence and digital cues make quality easier to judge.

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TOPIC 01

Customer decision journey



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TOPIC 01

Sources of perceived risk

1. **Functional**
   Will it solve the problem?

2. **Financial**
   Is the outcome worth the price?

3. **Time**
   Will access or delay create loss?

4. **Social**
   What will the choice signal to others?

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TOPIC 01

Competitive advantage versus empty claims

Perspective A

- Distinctive promise tied to a valued customer outcome.
- Capabilities and standards competitors cannot easily copy.
- Evidence from consistent delivery and recovery.

Perspective B

- Generic superlatives such as best, trusted or world-class.
- Visual refresh without operational change.
- A promise employees cannot explain or deliver.

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TOPIC 01

Brand value chain

1

Input

Strategy, research, talent, systems and service design.

2

Delivery

Touchpoint performance, employee behaviour and recovery.

3

Response

Awareness, trust, satisfaction, preference and advocacy.

4

Outcome

Retention, referral, revenue quality and strategic resilience.

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TOPIC 01

Differentiation must be experienced, not merely described.

The test is whether customers can name the difference and employees can reproduce it.

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REAL USE CASES

Applied Activities — Service Brand Value and Business Impact

Activity 1

- Babylist: Make an Intangible Service Easy to Trust

Activity 2

- DBS: Translate 'Live more, Bank less' into Business Value

Evidence boundary

- Named public case source
- Training assumptions clearly separated

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LEARNING UNIT 01

Babylist: Make an Intangible Service Easy to Trust

ACTIVITY 1

Use Shopify's Babylist example to diagnose how a service brand reduces risk and creates a clear reason to choose.

You'll build

Brand-value chain, proof inventory and competitive-advantage brief

Tools / evidence: Shopify case · customer-risk cards · value-chain template · evidence checklist

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ACTIVITY 1 · REAL USE CASE

Case Scenario — Public Facts and Training Guardrails

Reported / sourced

- Shopify presents Babylist as a service-brand example and describes service branding as building a recognisable identity and experience around an intangible offering.
- Source: https://www.shopify.com/sg/blog/service-branding

Training assumptions / limits

- The Singapore platform, customer interviews and commercial figures are fictional training inputs, not Babylist disclosures.
- Mock research shows first-time parents value reassurance, time saved and unbiased recommendations.
- The current landing page leads with features and has no process map, expert proof or outcome story.

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ACTIVITY 1 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Discussion Questions

1. Which functional, financial, time and social risks affect the customer's decision?

2. What brand benefits could matter to customers, employees and the business?

3. Which three tangible cues would make the promise easier to trust?

4. What is the defensible competitive advantage, and what evidence is still missing?

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ACTIVITY 1 · DEBRIEF AND ACCEPTANCE

Babylist: Make an Intangible Service Easy to Trust

✅ Test it

The submission separates facts from assumptions, links at least three proof cues to customer risk and business benefit, and states a defensible advantage with validation evidence.

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LEARNING UNIT 01

DBS: Translate 'Live more, Bank less' into Business Value

ACTIVITY 2

Use DBS's public brand promise to trace how a promise can influence customer experience and business outcomes.

You'll build

Promise-to-impact logic model and management narrative

Tools / evidence: DBS public promise · impact-chain canvas · counterfactual cards · debrief guide

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ACTIVITY 2 · REAL USE CASE

Case Scenario — Public Facts and Training Guardrails

Reported / sourced

- DBS states that its brand promise is 'Live more, Bank less' and describes making banking simple and effortless so customers can spend more time on what matters.
- Source: https://www.dbs.com/about-us/who-we-are/our-promise-to-you

Training assumptions / limits

- The regional bank and performance data are fictional; no DBS operating metrics are supplied or inferred.
- Small-business customers report repeated-document requests, slow onboarding and unclear case ownership.
- Management defines success as lower customer effort and faster time to first value, subject to compliance controls.

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ACTIVITY 2 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Discussion Questions

1. What customer outcome makes the DBS promise relevant rather than merely memorable?
2. Which service capabilities would be required to make a comparable promise credible?
3. How could improved delivery affect trust, retention, referral and cost-to-serve?
4. Which alternative explanations must be considered before claiming business impact?

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ACTIVITY 2 · DEBRIEF AND ACCEPTANCE

DBS: Translate 'Live more, Bank less' into Business Value

✅ Test it

The logic model contains capability, delivery, customer and business layers; every causal claim is labelled; and the proposed promise is original, relevant and deliverable.

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LEARNING UNIT RECAP

Recap — Service Brand Value and Business Impact

1

Babylist: Make an Intangible Service Easy to Trust

Explain the business impact and benefits of tangible service-brand proof

2

DBS: Translate 'Live more, Bank less' into Business Value

Demonstrate appreciation of a service brand and its competitive advantage

3

Evidence habit

Separate public facts, organisation evidence and training assumptions.

4

Management habit

Link each improvement to a decision, owner and review trigger.

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02

LEARNING UNIT 02

From Brand Strategy to Service Experience

purpose · audience · positioning · promise · touchpoints · tangible cues

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KEY CONCEPTS

Key Concepts — From Brand Strategy to Service Experience

1

Purpose

Clarifies the valued outcome and role the organisation chooses to play.

2

Positioning

Defines the audience, frame of reference, relevant difference and proof.

3

Promise

Turns positioning into an expectation that can be translated into service standards.

4

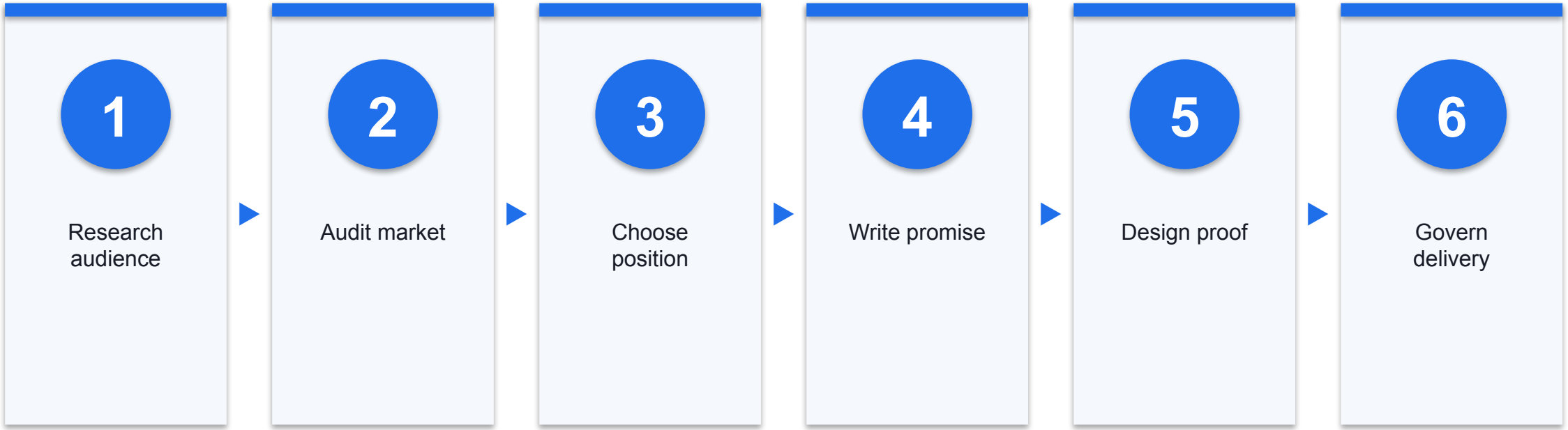
Touchpoints

Connect strategy to the moments before, during and after service delivery.

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TOPIC 02

Service-brand strategy sequence



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TOPIC 02

Audience insight

1

Jobs

What progress is the customer trying to make?

2

Pains

What risk, effort or uncertainty blocks progress?

3

Gains

What outcome and feeling define success?

4

Context

Who influences choice, use and renewal?

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TOPIC 02

Positioning choices

Perspective A

- Choose a specific priority audience and decision context.
- Name the valued difference and trade-off.
- Identify capabilities that make the claim credible.

Perspective B

- Trying to appeal equally to everyone weakens relevance.
- Copying category language creates sameness.
- A promise without operational proof raises disappointment risk.

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TOPIC 02

A practical brand promise

Relevant

- Connects to a meaningful customer outcome.

Distinctive

- Creates a recognisable reason to choose.

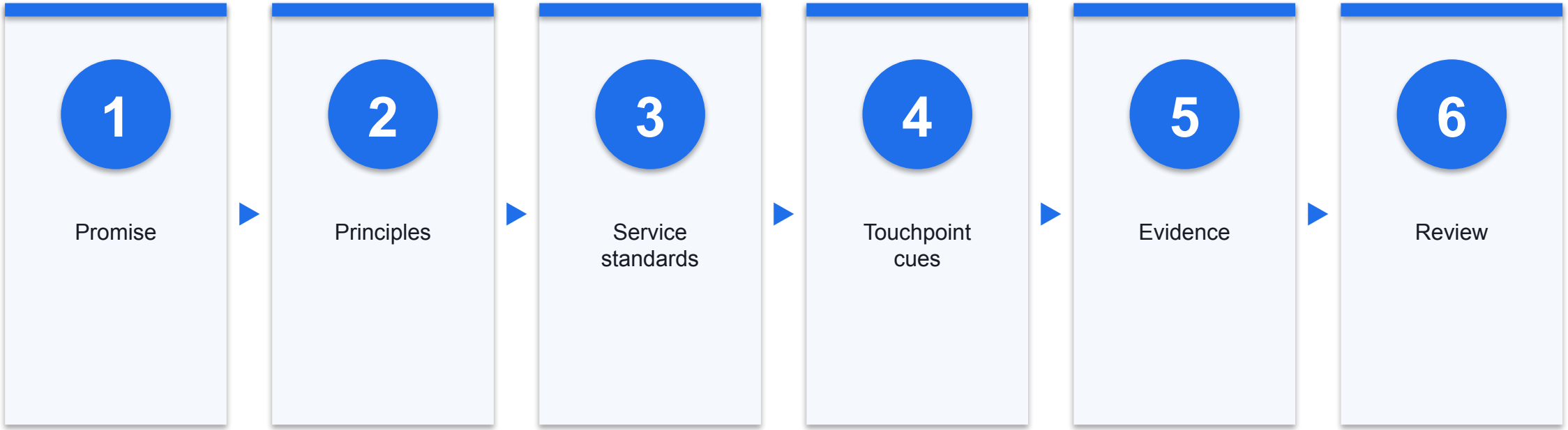
Deliverable

- Can be translated into behaviours, process and evidence.

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TOPIC 02

Promise-to-proof architecture



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TOPIC 02

Tangibilise the intangible

1

Show process

Explain stages, timelines, owners and what happens next.

2

Show expertise

Use credentials, cases, demonstrations and useful content.

3

Show outcomes

Use specific evidence and customer stories with context.

4

Show assurance

Set expectations, safeguards, access and recovery commitments.

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TOPIC 02

The service expansion of the marketing mix

1

Base layer

Product, price, place and promotion frame the offer but cannot by themselves carry an intangible promise.

2

People

The human actors who deliver the promise in real time and shape how it is remembered.

3

Process

Operational flow, waiting, sequencing and how much the customer is asked to do.

4

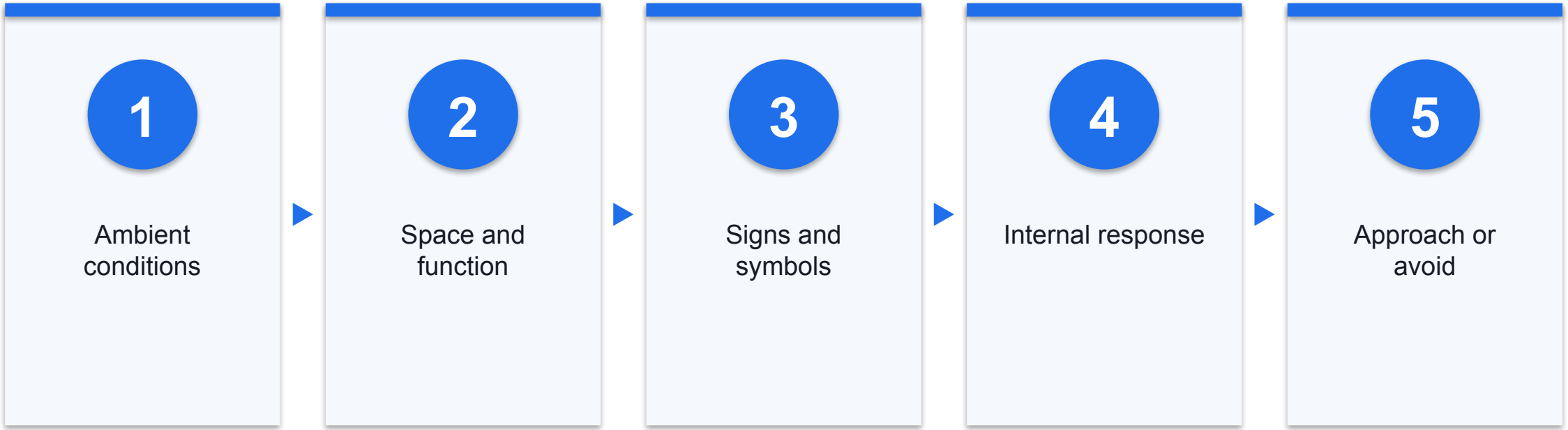
Physical evidence

The tangible and peripheral cues that signal the quality of something invisible.

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TOPIC 02

Physical space works as a behavioural stimulus



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TOPIC 02

Designing the servicescape

Stimulus · the environment

- Stimulus: ambient conditions, layout and equipment, signage, décor and brand livery.
- These cues act on customers and employees at the same time.
- They are read before anyone speaks, so they set the expectation the service must then meet.

Response · the behaviour

- Response: approach behaviour means explore, stay longer, engage and return.
- Avoidance behaviour means disengage, leave early and discount the promise.
- Digital environments carry the same load — layout, speed, clarity and tone are servicescape too.

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TOPIC 02

Service delivery as a staged performance

Front stage · visible

- Front stage is everything the customer can see: the setting, the interaction and the visible sequence.
- Frontline employees perform the promise, often doing emotional labour to hold it steady.
- The line of visibility marks where customer experience ends and operational mechanics begin.

Back stage · invisible

- Back stage is the support work, systems, training and management that make the front stage possible.
- Customers judge the front stage but failures usually originate behind the line.
- Blueprint both sides to find friction and fail points before customers do.

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TOPIC 02

Map moments that matter

1

Before

Discovery, search, enquiry, comparison and booking.

2

During

Welcome, diagnosis, delivery, waiting, handoff and payment.

3

After

Onboarding, follow-up, support, renewal and advocacy.

4

Failure

Recognition, ownership, recovery and learning.

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TOPIC 02

Standardise and personalise

Perspective A

- Standardise non-negotiable outcomes, safety, accuracy and brand-critical cues.
- Make handoffs and exception ownership visible.
- Measure whether the minimum promise is delivered.

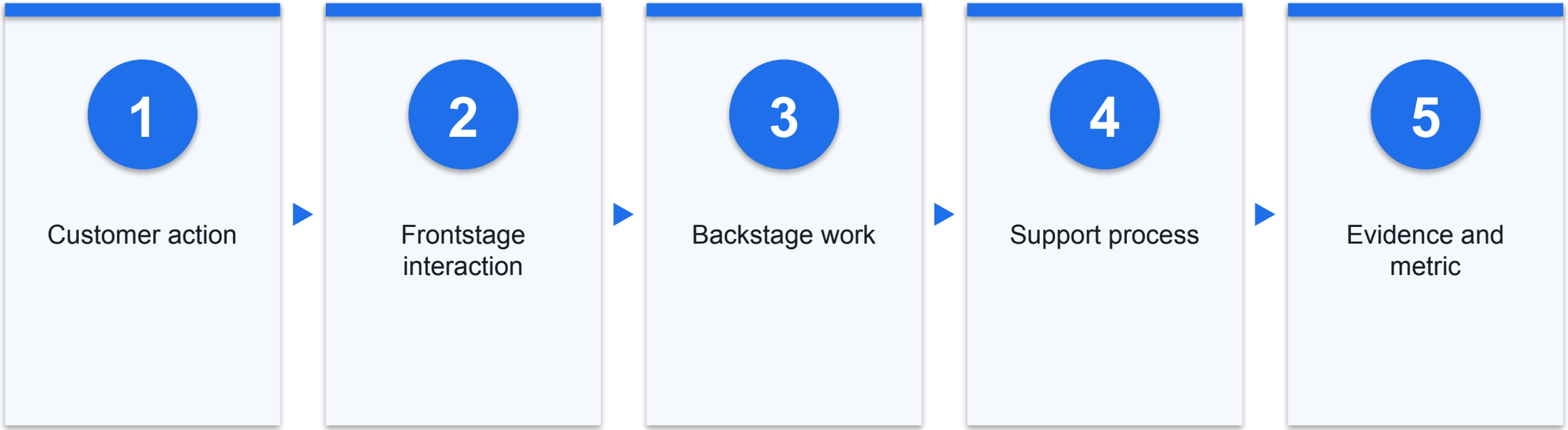
Perspective B

- Personalise language, recommendation, pace and support to customer context.
- Give employees bounded judgement, not unlimited discretion.
- Protect privacy and fairness when data drives personalisation.

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TOPIC 02

Service blueprint layers



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TOPIC 02

Consistency without sameness

1. **Outcome**
   The core benefit remains dependable.
2. **Character**
   The brand feels recognisable across channels.
3. **Context**
   Delivery adapts to channel and customer need.
4. **Control**
   Exceptions are owned, logged and learned from.

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TOPIC 02

Relationship-building mechanisms

Access

- Make expert help easy to reach.

Continuity

- Remember context and reduce repeated effort.

Reciprocity

- Create useful exchanges beyond the transaction.

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TOPIC 02

Strategy becomes real at the next customer touchpoint.

If the promise cannot guide a design or operating decision, it is still too vague.

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REAL USE CASES

Applied Activities — From Brand Strategy to Service Experience

Activity 3

- Ritz-Carlton: Promise-to-Proof Service Blueprint

Activity 4

- Starbucks: Redesign the Third-Place Journey

Evidence boundary

- Named public case source
- Training assumptions clearly separated

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LEARNING UNIT 02

Ritz-Carlton: Promise-to-Proof Service Blueprint

ACTIVITY 3

Use the Ritz-Carlton Gold Standards as a public reference for translating brand intent into observable delivery.

You'll build

Promise-to-proof architecture and five-layer service blueprint

Tools / evidence: Ritz-Carlton public standards · journey cards · blueprint template · peer review

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ACTIVITY 3 · REAL USE CASE

Case Scenario — Public Facts and Training Guardrails

Reported / sourced

- Ritz-Carlton publicly presents its Gold Standards —including its credo, motto and service values— as the foundation of its service culture.
- Source: https://www.ritzcarlton.com/en/services/standards/

Training assumptions / limits

- The eldercare concierge, personas and operational data are fictional and are not connected to Ritz-Carlton.
- Families value dignity, clarity, continuity and rapid escalation when care needs change.
- The organisation has 12 advisors across phone, WhatsApp and in-person channels.

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ACTIVITY 3 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Discussion Questions

1. What strategic promise should the concierge make, and to whom?
2. Which service principles and observable standards would make the promise real?
3. Where should delivery be standardised, and where should employees exercise judgement?
4. What physical or digital evidence would reassure families before and during service?

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ACTIVITY 3 · DEBRIEF AND ACCEPTANCE

Ritz-Carlton: Promise-to-Proof Service Blueprint

✅ Test it

The blueprint traces one promise through principles, observable standards, backstage enablers, tangible cues and measures, with explicit privacy and safeguarding guardrails.

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LEARNING UNIT 02

Starbucks: Redesign the Third-Place Journey

ACTIVITY 4

Use Starbucks's public mission as a lens for aligning positioning, environment, people and process across a service journey.

You'll build

Journey map, 7Ps alignment review and differentiated concept pitch

Tools / evidence: Starbucks public mission · persona cards · 7Ps canvas · concept scorecard

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ACTIVITY 4 · REAL USE CASE

Case Scenario — Public Facts and Training Guardrails

Reported / sourced

- Starbucks states a mission centred on coffee, the human spirit, connection and belonging, expressed through person, cup and neighbourhood.
- Source: https://about.starbucks.com/mission/

Training assumptions / limits

- The café, customer data, budget and constraints are fictional training inputs.
- Its priority segment is hybrid workers and nearby residents seeking calm, reliable social connection.
- The café can adjust layout, booking, host behaviour, menu presentation and community programming.

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ACTIVITY 4 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Discussion Questions

1. What customer job and emotional outcome should define the café's position?
2. Which 7Ps currently contradict the intended brand experience?
3. Which three moments could become distinctive and difficult to copy?
4. How will the team balance belonging, accessibility and commercial viability?

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ACTIVITY 4 · DEBRIEF AND ACCEPTANCE

Starbucks: Redesign the Third-Place Journey

✅ Test it

The future journey targets a defined audience, aligns all 7Ps, contains three signature moments with operational enablers, and addresses accessibility and viability trade-offs.

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LEARNING UNIT RECAP

Recap — From Brand Strategy to Service Experience

1

Ritz-Carlton: Promise-to-Proof Service Blueprint

Apply organisation branding strategy to service standards and touchpoints

2

Starbucks: Redesign the Third-Place Journey

Use a service-brand strategy to differentiate a real customer journey

3

Evidence habit

Separate public facts, organisation evidence and training assumptions.

4

Management habit

Link each improvement to a decision, owner and review trigger.

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Lunch Break

30 minutes

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03

LEARNING UNIT 03

Champion Adoption and Deliver the Promise

internal branding · leadership · employee enablement · culture · recovery

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KEY CONCEPTS

Key Concepts — Champion Adoption and Deliver the Promise

1

Internal brand

Employees need shared meaning, capability and reinforcement—not slogans alone.

2

Leadership

What leaders fund, model, recognise and correct signals the true brand.

3

Enablement

Training, tools, decision rights and feedback turn intent into repeatable action.

4

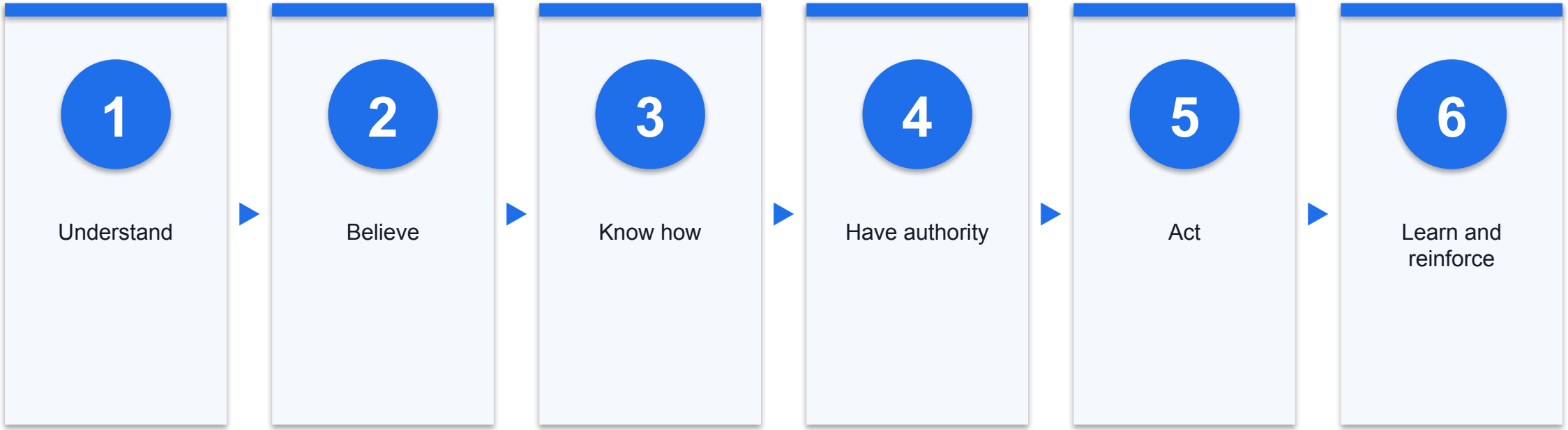
Recovery

A well-owned failure can restore confidence and reveal where the system must improve.

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TOPIC 03

Internal brand adoption



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TOPIC 03

Employee brand alignment

1

Meaning

Explain who the service is for and why the promise matters.

2

Role

Show how each function affects the customer outcome.

3

Capability

Practise the behaviours and judgement required.

4

Reinforcement

Align measures, recognition, coaching and consequences.

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TOPIC 03

Internal communication and internal branding

Perspective A

- Communication distributes messages and information.
- Awareness is necessary but not sufficient.
- Campaigns fade if systems reward different behaviour.

Perspective B

- Internal branding aligns culture, capability and operations with the promise.
- Employees test the promise against daily reality.
- Leaders must resolve contradictions.

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TOPIC 03

In a co-created service, the employee is the brand.

The gap that damages brands is between the promise marketing makes and the delivery employees execute at the moment of truth.

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TOPIC 03

Five inputs that build brand commitment

1

Internal communication

Top-down clarity about the promise combined with bottom-up feedback that is actually used.

2

Market information

Exposing staff to real customer feedback and competitor behaviour, not filtered summaries.

3

Brand training

Moving past generic service skills to teach the brand-specific behaviours this promise requires.

4

Brand leadership

Managers acting as visible role models, especially when the promise is costly to keep.

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TOPIC 03

Knowledge alone does not produce performance

Brand knowledge

Cognitive

I know what the brand stands for. Necessary, but on its own it changes nothing.

Brand commitment

Psychological bond

I believe in the brand and want it to succeed — an emotional attachment, not just compliance.

Brand performance

Behavioural output

I deliver the promise consistently at the moment of truth, including when it is inconvenient.

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TOPIC 03

Leader actions that build credibility

Model

- Use the language and standards in real decisions.

Enable

- Remove barriers and fund brand-critical capabilities.

Reinforce

- Recognise evidence and address promise-breaking behaviour.

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TOPIC 03

Brand champion network

1

Sponsor

Owns strategic commitment and cross-functional barriers.

2

Champions

Translate the promise into local context and collect feedback.

3

Managers

Coach performance and manage exceptions.

4

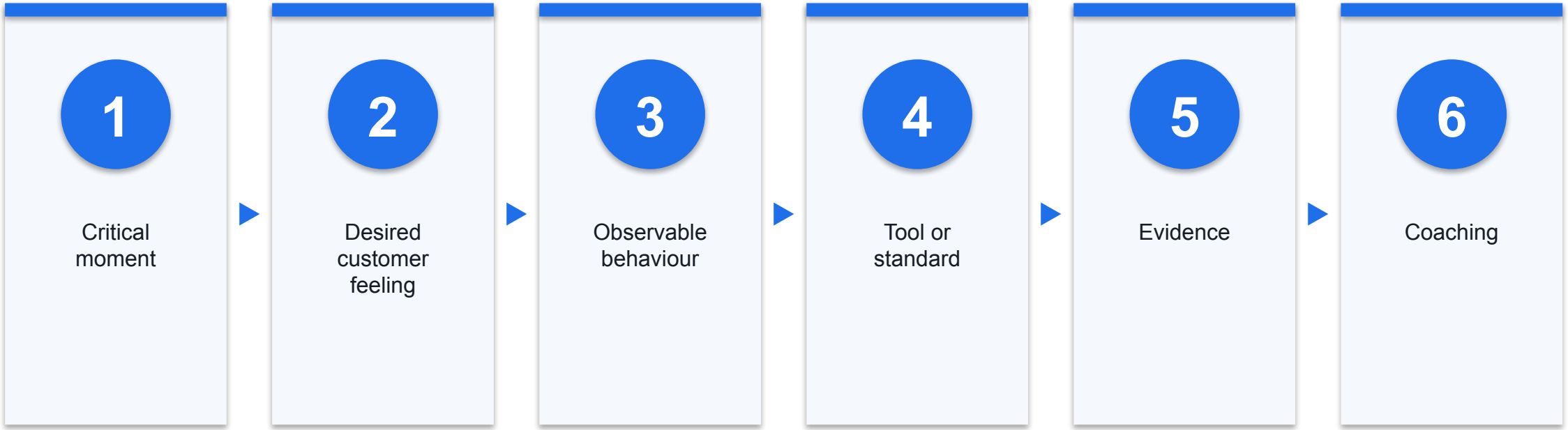
Employees

Deliver, observe, recover and improve the experience.

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TOPIC 03

Behaviour design



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TOPIC 03

Empowerment guardrails

1

Purpose

The outcome employees should protect.

2

Limits

Safety, privacy, legal and financial boundaries.

3

Authority

Decisions and resources available without escalation.

4

Escalation

Clear route when needs exceed authority.

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TOPIC 03

Storytelling with integrity

Perspective A

- Use specific customer and employee moments.
- Connect the action to the promise and outcome.
- Include tension, judgement and evidence.

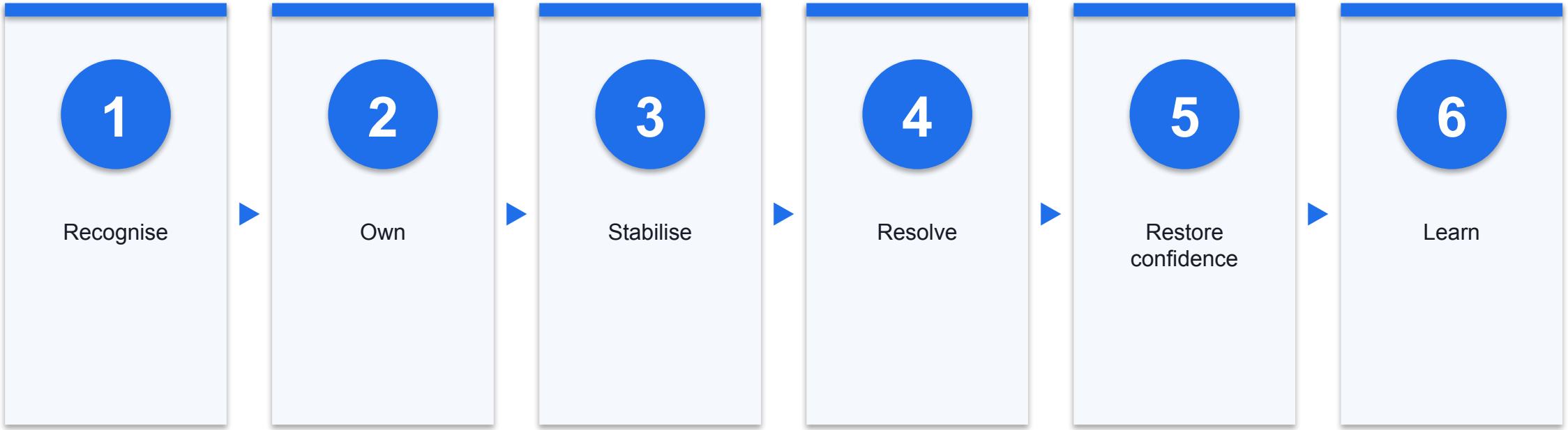
Perspective B

- Avoid invented testimonials or unsupported hero stories.
- Do not turn systemic failures into individual blame.
- Protect confidentiality and consent.

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TOPIC 03

Service-recovery loop



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TOPIC 03

Recovery dimensions

1

Outcome fairness

A reasonable fix, replacement or remedy.

2

Process fairness

Low effort, timely handling and clear ownership.

3

Interaction fairness

Respect, empathy and credible explanation.

4

Learning

Cause, action owner and prevention evidence.

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TOPIC 03

Adoption evidence

Leading

- Training completion, confidence, tool use and coaching.

Behaviour

- Observed standards, handoff quality and recovery ownership.

Outcome

- Customer experience, rework, retention and referrals.

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TOPIC 03

Employees cannot deliver a promise the organisation does not enable.

Internal branding is the operating system behind the external claim.

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REAL USE CASES

Applied Activities — Champion Adoption and Deliver the Promise

Activity 5

- Zappos: Build an Internal Brand Adoption System

Activity 6

- Airbnb: Recover Trust Across a Service Ecosystem

Evidence boundary

- Named public case source
- Training assumptions clearly separated

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LEARNING UNIT 03

Zappos: Build an Internal Brand Adoption System

ACTIVITY 5

Use Zappos's public culture materials to design an adoption system that aligns meaning, capability and reinforcement.

You'll build

Internal-brand charter, champion network and 30-day adoption sprint

Tools / evidence: Zappos culture source · stakeholder map · behaviour cards · adoption dashboard

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ACTIVITY 5 · REAL USE CASE

Case Scenario — Public Facts and Training Guardrails

Reported / sourced

- Zappos Insights publicly describes a culture shaped by core values and employee behaviours, and offers culture-focused learning based on the company's experience.
- Source: https://www.zapposinsights.com/about/culture

Training assumptions / limits

- The marketplace, interview statements and performance data are fictional and not Zappos information.
- Employees understand the words but lack examples, authority and aligned performance measures.
- Field partners are contractors; adoption must include onboarding and quality governance.

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ACTIVITY 5 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Discussion Questions

1. What must employees understand, believe, know and be able to do?
2. Which three behaviours best express dependable care at critical moments?
3. What systems currently contradict the promise?
4. How should champions, managers and leaders reinforce adoption?

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ACTIVITY 5 · DEBRIEF AND ACCEPTANCE

Zappos: Build an Internal Brand Adoption System

✅ Test it

The plan names role-specific behaviours, tools and guardrails; assigns sponsor/champion/manager ownership; and includes leading, behavioural and outcome evidence.

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LEARNING UNIT 03

Airbnb: Recover Trust Across a Service Ecosystem

ACTIVITY 6

Use Airbnb's public description of its community marketplace to design brand-consistent recovery across customer, provider and platform roles.

You'll build

Service-recovery playbook, decision matrix and learning loop

Tools / evidence: Airbnb public facts · incident cards · recovery matrix · debrief record

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ACTIVITY 6 · REAL USE CASE

Case Scenario — Public Facts and Training Guardrails

Reported / sourced

- Airbnb describes itself as a community built around connection, enabled by hosts offering stays and experiences to guests through its platform.
- Source: https://news.airbnb.com/about-us/

Training assumptions / limits

- The booking platform, incident, family and financial amounts are fictional and not an Airbnb event.
- The booking value is S$480 and an alternative provider is available at S$620 two hours later.
- Frontline agents may approve S$150 without escalation; safety and fraud flags require specialist review.

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ACTIVITY 6 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Discussion Questions

1. What outcome, process and interaction fairness does the customer need?
2. Who owns the recovery when value is co-created by several parties?
3. What authority and guardrails should frontline employees have?
4. What evidence would show confidence is restored and the system improved?

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ACTIVITY 6 · DEBRIEF AND ACCEPTANCE

Airbnb: Recover Trust Across a Service Ecosystem

✅ Test it

The playbook protects outcome/process/interaction fairness, assigns ecosystem ownership, respects authority limits, and closes with a verified improvement action.

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LEARNING UNIT RECAP

Recap — Champion Adoption and Deliver the Promise

1

Zappos: Build an Internal Brand Adoption System

Champion adoption of the service brand through culture and employee enablement

2

Airbnb: Recover Trust Across a Service Ecosystem

Champion the service brand during failure and recovery

3

Evidence habit

Separate public facts, organisation evidence and training assumptions.

4

Management habit

Link each improvement to a decision, owner and review trigger.

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04

LEARNING UNIT 04

Evaluate and Improve Service-Brand Impact

measurement system · KPI logic · journey evidence · diagnosis · improvement

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KEY CONCEPTS

Key Concepts — Evaluate and Improve Service-Brand Impact

1

System

Use a balanced chain of measures rather than one headline score.

2

Causality

Connect employee and operational drivers to customer and business outcomes.

3

Segmentation

Averages hide differences by journey, channel, audience and recovery status.

4

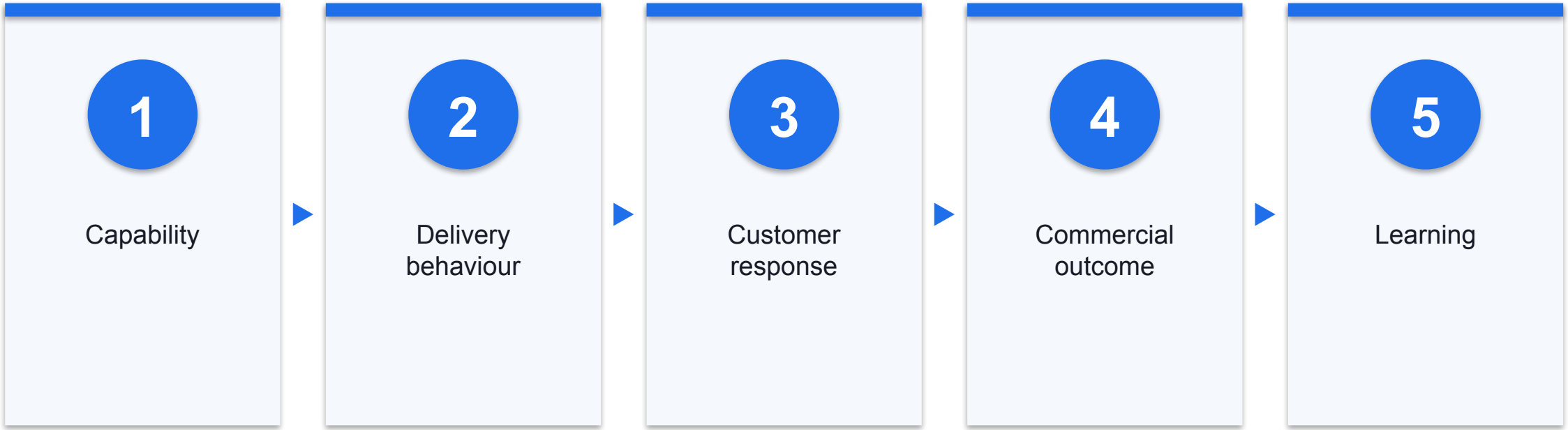
Action

Every measure needs a decision, owner, threshold and review cadence.

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TOPIC 04

Brand-impact measurement chain



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TOPIC 04

Four measurement lenses

1

Customer

Awareness, consideration, trust, effort, satisfaction and advocacy.

2

Employee

Understanding, belief, confidence, enablement and observed behaviour.

3

Operational

Accuracy, wait, resolution, handoff, recovery and consistency.

4

Commercial

Conversion, retention, referral, share of wallet and revenue quality.

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TOPIC 04

Leading and lagging indicators

Perspective A

- Leading: training, confidence, staffing, standard adherence and response time.
- They provide earlier signals and can be influenced directly.
- They do not prove customer or commercial impact alone.

Perspective B

- Lagging: trust, retention, referrals, complaints and revenue outcomes.
- They confirm accumulated results but arrive later.
- They may be affected by price, seasonality and market conditions.

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TOPIC 04

Common customer measures

NPS

- Relationship or journey advocacy; pair with reasons and behaviour.

CSAT

- Satisfaction with a defined interaction or outcome.

CES

- Effort required to complete a task or resolve an issue.

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TOPIC 04

Qualitative evidence

1

Interviews

Explore meaning, trade-offs and unmet needs.

2

Observation

See actual behaviour and friction in context.

3

Reviews

Detect repeated language, moments and expectations.

4

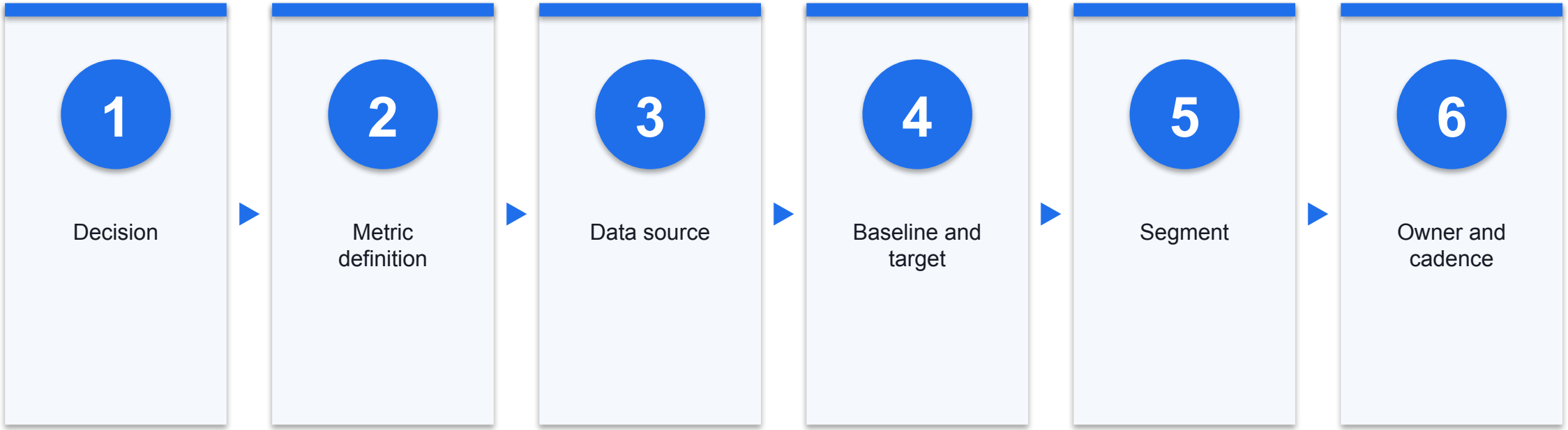
Complaints

Reveal failure patterns, ownership and recovery quality.

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TOPIC 04

Build a useful KPI



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TOPIC 04

Measurement quality checks

1. **Valid**
   Represents the construct or outcome claimed.

2. **Reliable**
   Produces comparable results under defined conditions.

3. **Timely**
   Available before the decision window closes.

4. **Actionable**
   Has a clear owner and response threshold.

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TOPIC 04

Correlation and contribution

Perspective A

- Track whether brand-related changes move with experience and business results.
- Use journey and segment comparisons to narrow explanations.
- State uncertainty and alternative drivers.

Perspective B

- Avoid claiming one campaign caused all commercial change.
- Use experiments, phased rollout or matched comparison where feasible.
- Triangulate quantitative and qualitative evidence.

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TOPIC 04

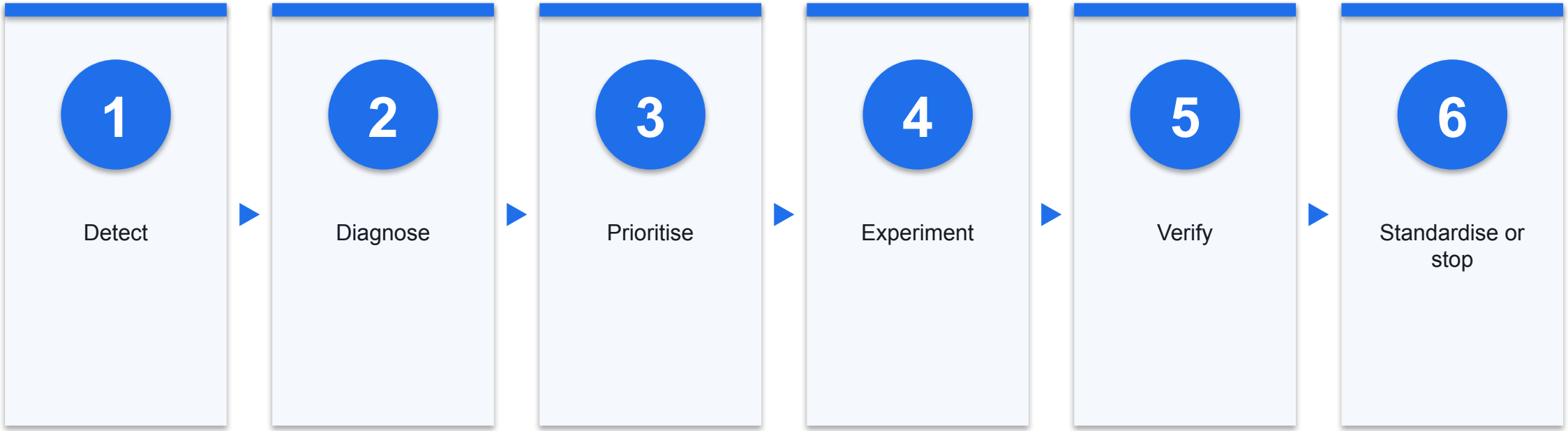
Dashboard design

1. **Promise**
   The customer outcome the dashboard tests.
2. **Signal**
   A small set of driver and outcome measures.
3. **Context**
   Target, trend, segment and notable change.
4. **Action**
   Owner, decision, due date and expected effect.

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TOPIC 04

Insight-to-improvement cycle



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TOPIC 04

Evaluation cadences

Operational

- Daily or weekly exceptions and recovery.

Journey

- Monthly performance and qualitative themes.

Strategic

- Quarterly position, portfolio and investment choices.

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TOPIC 04

The architecture of value actualisation

The philosophy

Service-dominant logic

Shift focus from selling objects to co-creating value-in-use with the customer.

Seamless service performance

The output

The engine

Internal branding

Align, equip and empower the people who deliver the promise.

The stage

Servicescape and process

Design the physical, digital and operational environment that guides behaviour.

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TOPIC 04

Four strategic imperatives for an intangible economy

1

Sell outcomes, not objects

Define the proposition around the capability enabled, not the item distributed.

2

Blueprint the theatre

Map front-stage interaction and back-stage process to remove friction and locate fail points.

3

Use the environment

Treat physical and digital space as a signal of quality that shapes what customers do.

4

Build from the inside out

Fund internal capability as seriously as external marketing; employees are the brand asset.

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TOPIC 04

A metric is useful only when it changes a decision.

Measure the promise, diagnose the experience and close the improvement loop.

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REAL USE CASES

Applied Activities — Evaluate and Improve Service-Brand Impact

Activity 7

- Singapore Airlines: Design a Balanced Brand-Impact Scorecard

Activity 8

- BOP Design: Evaluate a Human B2B Brand in an AI-Saturated Market

Evidence boundary

- Named public case source
- Training assumptions clearly separated

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LEARNING UNIT 04

Singapore Airlines: Design a Balanced Brand-Impact Scorecard

ACTIVITY 7

Use Singapore Airlines's public service story as the context for a scorecard that connects employee capability, delivery and customer outcomes.

You'll build

KPI dictionary, balanced scorecard and monthly review agenda

Tools / evidence: SIA public story · KPI cards · mock journey data · metric-quality checklist

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ACTIVITY 7 · REAL USE CASE

Case Scenario — Public Facts and Training Guardrails

Reported / sourced

- Singapore Airlines publicly describes a longstanding focus on service excellence, innovation and the Singapore Girl as part of its brand story.
- Source: https://www.singaporeair.com/en_UK/us/about-us/our-story/

Training assumptions / limits

- The airline, promise and dataset are fictional and must not be attributed to Singapore Airlines.
- The mock data includes employee confidence, departure communication, first-contact resolution, effort, satisfaction, complaints and repeat booking.
- The dashboard has space for eight measures and must support a monthly management decision.

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ACTIVITY 7 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Discussion Questions

1. Which leading and lagging measures best test the promise?
2. How should results be segmented to expose inconsistency?
3. Which metric definitions or data sources could mislead management?
4. What threshold should trigger action, and who owns the response?

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ACTIVITY 7 · DEBRIEF AND ACCEPTANCE

Singapore Airlines: Design a Balanced Brand-Impact Scorecard

✅ Test it

Every KPI has a decision, definition, source, owner and threshold; the set balances four evidence lenses; and the analysis identifies a segment-level action without unsupported causal claims.

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LEARNING UNIT 04

BOP Design: Evaluate a Human B2B Brand in an AI-Saturated Market

ACTIVITY 8

Use BOP Design's 2026–2027 trend perspective to build an evaluation plan for a real B2B professional-service context.

You'll build

Evaluation design, evidence synthesis and 90-day experiment brief

Tools / evidence: BOP Design article · research matrix · mock funnel data · experiment canvas

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ACTIVITY 8 · REAL USE CASE

Case Scenario — Public Facts and Training Guardrails

Reported / sourced

- BOP Design argues that B2B brands in 2026–2027 need coherent systems, human relevance, strategic AI use, clearer data communication and consistency across machine- and human-mediated discovery.
- Source: https://www.bopdesign.com/bop-blog/b2b-branding-trends-for-2026-and-2027/

Training assumptions / limits

- The advisory firm, research quotes and funnel data are fictional training inputs, not BOP Design client results.
- The team can run interviews, analyse search/enquiry data and test one website/service-introduction change over 90 days.
- The firm promises 'Clear decisions in complex cyber risk'.

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ACTIVITY 8 · DISCUSS AND DECIDE

Discussion Questions

1. Which evidence would distinguish awareness growth from stronger brand preference?
2. How can the firm test whether generic AI-mediated content weakened trust?
3. What human and system cues should be evaluated across the buyer journey?
4. Which 90-day experiment offers the clearest learning at acceptable risk?

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ACTIVITY 8 · DEBRIEF AND ACCEPTANCE

BOP Design: Evaluate a Human B2B Brand in an AI-Saturated Market

✅ Test it

The evaluation triangulates at least three evidence types, states limitations and alternative explanations, and defines an ethical experiment with success, guardrail and stop/scale criteria.

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LEARNING UNIT RECAP

Recap — Evaluate and Improve Service-Brand Impact

1

Singapore Airlines: Design a Balanced Brand-Impact Scorecard

Evaluate service-brand impact using balanced evidence

2

BOP Design: Evaluate a Human B2B Brand in an AI-Saturated Market

Evaluate current service-brand impact and recommend an evidence-based improvement

3

Evidence habit

Separate public facts, organisation evidence and training assumptions.

4

Management habit

Link each improvement to a decision, owner and review trigger.

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WRAP-UP

Make the Promise Observable and Measurable

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COURSE SUMMARY

What You Achieved

1

LO1

Explain how a service brand creates business impact, trust, differentiation and customer value.

2

LO2

Apply an organisation's brand strategy to service promises, touchpoints and competitive advantage.

3

LO3

Champion service-brand adoption through employees, communication, experience design and recovery.

4

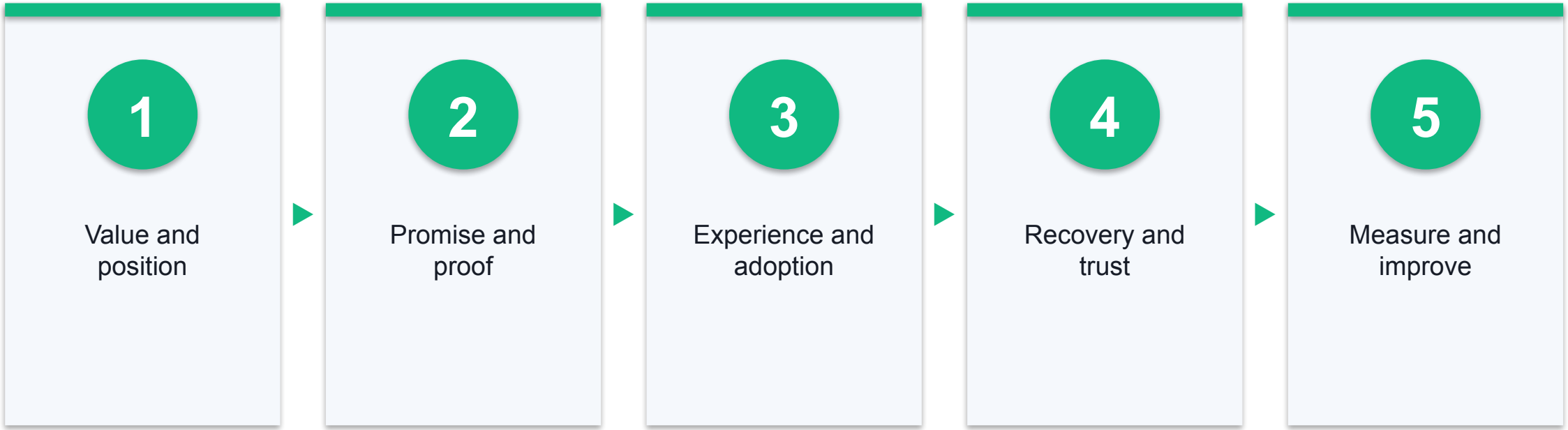
LO4

Evaluate service-brand impact using customer, employee, operational and commercial evidence.

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TAKEAWAY

The complete service-brand discipline



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COURSE ENRICHMENT

Evidence Sources

1. **Shopify — Service branding strategies**
   https://www.shopify.com/sg/blog/service-branding

2. **Lume — Branding in service marketing**
   https://www.lumeishere.com/blog/branding-in-service-marketing?p=4rihRRyWXheesz5AS

3. **become.team — Service branding**
   https://become.team/blogs/service-branding

4. **BrandExtract — Branding a service**
   https://www.brandextract.com/Insights/Articles/Branding-a-Service-3-Strategies-That-Work/

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COURSE ENRICHMENT

Evidence Sources — Continued

1

LinkedIn — Service-industry branding

https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/branding-service-industry-strategies-differentiating-your-singh-xgope/

2

MAD Designs — Branding in the service industry

https://www.maddesigns.in/blog/what-is-the-role-of-branding-in-the-service-industry/

3

SLM — Building a strong service brand

https://slm.mba/mmpm-005/building-strong-service-brand-process-strategies/

4

Scribd — Branding of services

https://www.scribd.com/presentation/439218850/branding-of-services

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COURSE ENRICHMENT

Evidence Sources — Continued

1. **GBMR — Internal branding in services**
   https://www.gbmrjournal.com/pdf/vol.%2010%20no.%204/V10N4_3.pdf

2. **Phable — Service branding and service-dominant logic**
   https://www.phable.io/phable-labs/service-branding-service-dominant-logic

3. **Wikipedia — Services marketing**
   https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Services_marketing

4. **Vargo & Lusch — Service-dominant logic (value-in-use and co-creation)**
   https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Service-dominant_logic

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COURSE ENRICHMENT

Evidence Sources — Continued

1. **Bitner — The servicescape and stimulus–response behaviour**
   https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Servicescape

2. **BOP Design — B2B branding trends 2026–2027**
   https://www.bopdesign.com/bop-blog/b2b-branding-trends-for-2026-and-2027/

3. **DBS — Our promise to you**
   https://www.dbs.com/about-us/who-we-are/our-promise-to-you

4. **Zappos Insights — Culture**
   https://www.zapposinsights.com/about/culture

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COURSE ENRICHMENT

Evidence Sources — Continued

1

Airbnb — About us

https://news.airbnb.com/about-us/

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BEFORE YOU LEAVE

Course Feedback

1

Share

Complete the course feedback form before you leave.

2

Improve

Your comments help us refine this course.

3

Certificate

Your certificate of completion is emailed after the course.

4

Keep learning

Revisit the slides, Learner Guide and activities.

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SERVICE BRAND

Thank You

Build a clear promise, enable people to deliver it and improve with evidence.

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